

Lab 1 · Week 1 · Teacher Guide

The One-Prompt Game · Sundays 1:30 to 3:30 · Aasees Sethi · Caution Tape

What they learn today

- A website is files that travel to your laptop, and the browser builds them.
- HTML is the stuff, CSS is the looks, JavaScript is the moves.
- Codex is a helper. It can't read your mind. If you don't say it, it guesses.
- A 3-line plan (PRD) tells Codex what to build. They're the boss of the plan.

Your project: Dragon Dash

- You build your own game every class, doing the same step as the kids, with a clearer plan.
- The line to repeat: my game is better because my plan is clearer, not because my AI is better.

Before class

- Open tabs: slides, demo-arcade.ct839.dev, Bone Run, VS Code with an empty dragon-dash folder.
- Test the Dragon Dash plan and prompt at home. Save the result as a backup.
- Whiteboard: demo-arcade.ct839.dev · my-arcade · Ctrl+Shift+P then Codex: Open Codex Sidebar.
- Ask the front desk which kids have ChatGPT and GitHub accounts. Ask parents to stay for the first hour.

Slide controls

- F: full screen · Right arrow or clicker: next · Left arrow: back.
- S: start or pause the timer · R: reset it.
- Quizzes: click the answer a kid picks. Wrong shakes, right turns green.

Run of show

#	Time	What happens
1	1:30 to 1:40	Welcome
2	1:40 to 1:42	Meet Aasees + Bone Run
3	1:42 to 1:45	Today's missions
4	1:45 to 1:50	Mission 1: crack the calculator
5	1:50 to 1:57	Play all 3 games
6	1:57 to 2:00	Detective time
7	2:00 to 2:04	How did the game get on your screen?
8	2:04 to 2:08	3 things every game is made of
9	2:08 to 2:12	Build it layer by layer
10	2:12 to 2:16	Quiz 1 of 3
11	2:16 to 2:19	Mission 2: meet Codex
12	2:19 to 2:31	Get your tools, part 1

#	Time	What happens
13	2:31 to 2:40	Get your tools, part 2
14	2:40	You did it!
15	2:41 to 2:44	Quiz 2 of 3
16	2:44 to 2:54	Snack break
17	2:54 to 2:56	Mission 3: "make a game"
18	2:56 to 2:59	Write your plan in 3 lines
19	2:59 to 3:03	Watch me build mine: Dragon Dash
20	3:03 to 3:10	Your turn: write your plan
21	3:10 to 3:12	Send it to Codex
22	3:12 to 3:17	Play it and check
23	3:17 to 3:22	My story + swap
24	3:22 to 3:26	Quiz 3 of 3
25	3:26 to 3:30	Show off + next week

Lab 1 • Week 1

Hey builders! 🖐️

Today you're making your very own video game.

For real. 😊

While we wait: what's your favourite game?



Slide 1 of 25

1:30 to 1:40 • 10 min

Welcome

Goal: Kids settle in and feel welcome. You learn names.

Say: Hey! Grab a seat, open your laptop, plug in your charger. While we wait, what's your name and your favourite video game?

Do: Walk seat to seat. Write each name and game on your phone. Ask parents to stay in the lobby for the first hour (they approve sign-ins later).

Kids do: Arrive, open laptops, tell you their favourite game.

If stuck: No charger or dead laptop: sit them next to a buddy for now.

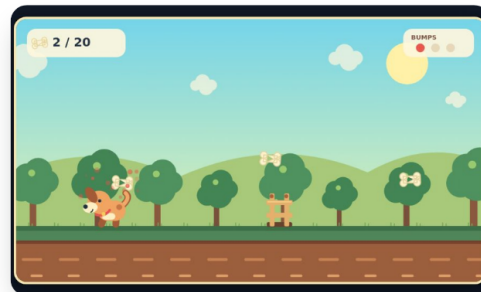
I'm Aasees



I make apps and games for my job.

I made this one with AI.
It's called **Bone Run** 🐕👉

Today, you make yours!



Slide 2 of 25

1:40 to 1:42 • 2 min

Meet Aasees + Bone Run

Goal: They see you build real games, and they'll make one today.

Say: I'm Aasees. I make apps and games for my job. I made this one with AI. It's called Bone Run. Today, you make yours!

Do: Alt-tab to Bone Run and play for 20 seconds. Crash into a mud puddle on purpose, kids love it. Keep this whole slide under 2 minutes.

Kids do: Watch and react.

Today's missions



Mission 1

Crack the secret arcade



Mission 2

Get your builder tools



Mission 3

Make your first game

And by Week 3, your game is on the internet for anyone to play! 

Slide 3 of 25

1:42 to 1:45 • 3 min

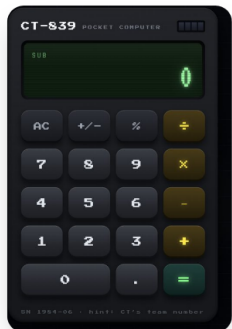
Today's missions

Goal: They know the plan for today, so everything feels like progress.

Say: Today has 3 missions. Mission 1, crack a secret arcade. Mission 2, get your builder tools. Mission 3, make your first game. And by Week 3, your game is on the internet for anyone to play.

Do: Point to each mission card as you say it. Every later slide has a mission tag in the corner so they always know where they are.

Kids do: Listen. Maybe cheer.



Mission 1

There's a secret arcade hiding in this calculator! 

`demo-arcade.ct839.dev`

Find the secret number. First one in wins!



Hint: read the tiny writing at the bottom. Press AC first!

3:00 Tap to start



Slide 4 of 25

1:45 to 1:50 • 5 min

Mission 1: crack the calculator

Goal: Hands-on fun right away. They explore a real web game before any teaching.

Say: Open this website. There's a secret arcade hiding in this calculator. Find the secret number. First one in wins!

Do: Write demo-arcade.ct839.dev on the board. Press S to start the 3 minute timer. At 2 minutes, press the right arrow to show the hint. Shout out the first kid who gets in.

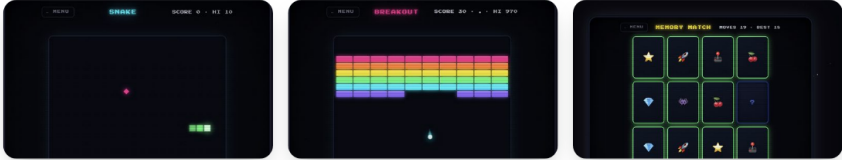
Kids do: Type the address, poke at the calculator, find the code.

If stuck: The answer is 839 then =. If a kid pressed other buttons first, they need AC to clear it.

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Mission 1

You're in! Play all 3 games



 **Snake**  **Breakout**  **Memory**

5:00 Tap to start  

Slide 5 of 25

1:50 to 1:57 • 7 min

Play all 3 games

Goal: They play real games and start noticing how they're built.

Say: You're in! Play Snake, Breakout and Memory. Die at least once. While you play, notice what every game has.

Do: Press S for 5 minutes. Walk around and play along with a couple of kids.

Kids do: Play all three games.

If stuck: Kid stuck on one game the whole time: nudge them to try the other two.

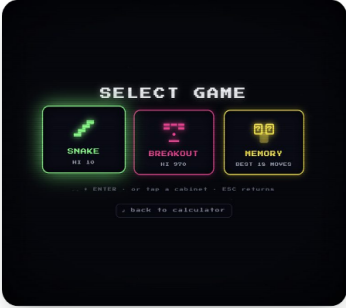
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Detective time

What did ALL 3 games have?

-  **A score**
-  **A Menu button**
-  **A best score**

Your arcade is going to have these too!



Slide 6 of 25

1:57 to 2:00 • 3 min

Detective time

Goal: They discover the 3 things every arcade game has. Their arcade will have these by Week 4.

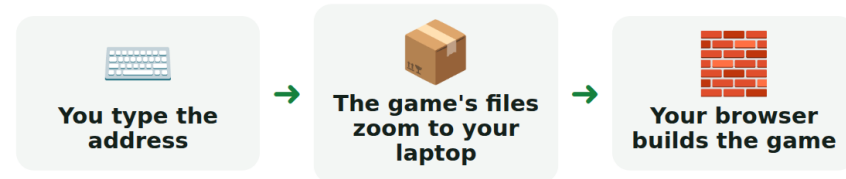
Say: Detective time! What did ALL three games have? Shout it out.

Do: Let them guess first. Then press the right arrow for each: a score, a Menu button, a best score. One more press shows "Your arcade is going to have these too."

Kids do: Shout answers.

Wait... how did the game get on your screen? 🤔

You didn't download anything. You just typed an address!



🧑‍🔧 It's like ordering LEGO: the box arrives, then you build it.

Slide 7 of 25

Every web game is made of 3 things 🤖



🤖 Like a robot: HTML is its body, CSS is its paint, JavaScript is its brain.

Slide 8 of 25

2:00 to 2:04 • 4 min

How did the game get on your screen?

Goal: First tech idea: a website is files that travel to your laptop and get built by the browser.

Say: Wait. How did that game get on your screen? You didn't download anything. You typed an address. Then the game's files zoomed to your laptop. Then your browser built the game.

Do: Press the right arrow for each box and act it out (mime typing, catching a box, building). Last press shows the LEGO line: it's like ordering LEGO, the box arrives, then you build it.

Kids do: Listen and answer: what arrives first, the box or the built LEGO?

2:04 to 2:08 • 4 min

3 things every game is made of

Goal: HTML, CSS, JavaScript. The most important idea for Weeks 1 to 3.

Say: Every web game is made of 3 things. HTML is the stuff on the screen. CSS is how it looks. JavaScript is how it moves. Like a robot: HTML is its body, CSS is its paint, JavaScript is its brain.

Do: Press the right arrow to show the robot line. Then ask quick questions: I want my robot pink, which one? (CSS) I want it to dance? (JavaScript) I want to give it a third arm? (HTML)

Kids do: Shout the answers.

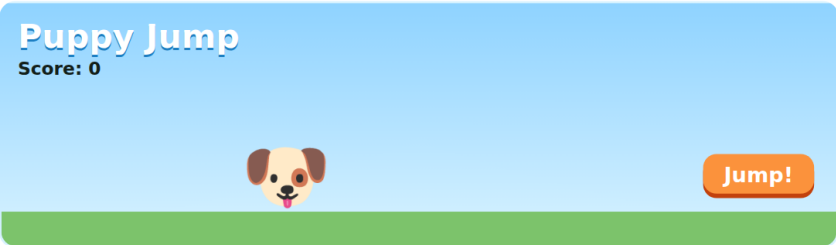
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Let's build one together, layer by layer

 Just HTML  + CSS  + JavaScript

Puppy Jump

Score: 0



Now it has a brain. Click Jump!

Slide 9 of 25

2:08 to 2:12 • 4 min

Build it layer by layer

Goal: They SEE each layer get added to a real mini game.

Say: Let's build one together. Watch what each layer does.

Do: Click the buttons in order. Just HTML: everything is there but it looks plain, click Jump, nothing happens. + CSS: now it looks like a game, click Jump, still nothing, ask why (no brain yet). + JavaScript: invite a kid up to click Jump and watch the score go up.

Kids do: Guess what will happen before each click. One kid gets to click Jump.

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? Quiz 1 of 3 Class score: 1 / 3 ★

Which one would you fix?

There's no score on the screen.

☒ A  HTML ☐ B  CSS ☐ C  JavaScript

Something's missing? That's HTML 

The title is tiny and grey.

☐ A  HTML ☐ B  CSS ☐ C  JavaScript

I press the arrow keys and nothing moves.

☐ A  HTML ☐ B  CSS ☐ C  JavaScript

Slide 10 of 25

2:12 to 2:16 • 4 min

Quiz 1 of 3

Goal: Check they understood HTML, CSS and JavaScript. This is exactly next week's skill.

Say: Quiz time! Which one would you fix?

Do: Read each question. Kids shout A, B or C. Pick one kid to click. Green means right and shows why. Red shakes, let them try again. The class score in the corner counts first tries.

Kids do: Shout answers, one kid clicks.

If stuck: Answers: 1 A (HTML, something's missing). 2 B (CSS, looks bad). 3 C (JavaScript, nothing moves).

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Mission 2

Meet your robot helper: Codex


You tell it what you want

→


It writes the code for you

→


You test it and check

 **But it can't read your mind! If you don't say it, it guesses.**

Slide 11 of 25

2:16 to 2:19 • 3 min

Mission 2: meet Codex

Goal: They understand Codex is a helper that only knows what they tell it.

Say: Mission 2! Meet your robot helper, Codex. You tell it what you want, it writes the code for you, then you test it and check. But it can't read your mind. If you don't say it, it guesses.

Do: Press the right arrow through the 3 boxes, then the last line. Say the last line twice, it comes back in Mission 3.

Kids do: Listen.

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Mission 2

Get your tools, part 1


Step 1
Get VS Code
This is where you build.
code.visualstudio.com


Step 2
Add Codex
Your robot helper. Pick the one by
OpenAI.


Step 3
Sign in
Your parent says yes on their
phone or laptop.

 **Watch out for fake Codex! Check it says OpenAI.**
Done? 👍 **Thumbs up! Already set up?** 🚀 **You're my helper today.**

12:00 Tap to start

↻

Slide 12 of 25

2:19 to 2:31 • 12 min

Get your tools, part 1

Goal: VS Code installed. Codex installed and signed in.

Say: Everyone do this with me, one step at a time. Thumbs up when you're done with each one.

Do: Do every step on the projector at their speed. Step 1: code.visualstudio.com, Download (Windows: tick Create a desktop icon. Mac: drag to Applications). Step 2: Extensions icon (Ctrl+Shift+X, Mac Cmd+Shift+X), search Codex, pick the one by OpenAI with the blue check. Step 3: Codex panel, Sign in with ChatGPT, parent approves. Press S for 12 minutes.

Kids do: Install and sign in. Returning kids who are already set up become helpers.

If stuck: No Codex panel: Ctrl+Shift+P, type Codex: Open Codex Sidebar. Parent not there: buddy that kid with a neighbour and follow up after class.

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Mission 2

Get your tools, part 2

Step 4
Add Live Server
Shows your game in the browser.

Step 5
Make a folder
Call it my-arcade . Open it in VS Code.

Step 6
Test it!
Paste this into Codex, then click Go Live.

Create a file named `index.html` that shows "Hello from my arcade" in big letters.

9:00 Tap to start

Slide 13 of 25

2:31 to 2:40 · 9 min

Get your tools, part 2

Goal: Live Server installed, my-arcade folder open, first page made by Codex and showing in the browser.

Say: Live Server makes your laptop pretend to be a website, just for you. Make a folder called my-arcade, spelled exactly like that, because in Week 3 it becomes your website name. Then paste this into Codex and click Go Live.

Do: Step 4: Extensions, Live Server by Ritwick Dey. Step 5: Documents, new folder my-arcade, VS Code, File, Open Folder, Yes I trust the authors. Step 6: paste the prompt into Codex, allow it to create the file, click Go Live bottom right. Press S for 9 minutes.

Kids do: Install, make the folder, send their first prompt.

If stuck: No Go Live button: close VS Code fully and reopen. Browser shows a list of files: click `index.html`.

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You did it!

If you see this, you just made your first web page.
That was the hardest part of the whole course!

Hello from my arcade

Slide 14 of 25

2:40 · 1 min

You did it!

Goal: Celebrate. Setup is the hardest part of the whole course.

Say: If you see this, you just made your first web page! That was the hardest part of the whole course. Seriously.

Do: Big energy. Clap. Note anyone still stuck and help them during the break.

Kids do: Cheer.

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? Quiz 2 of 3

Class score: 1 / 3 ★

1. What does Codex do?

A Plays games for you

B Writes code for you

C Fixes your laptop

Codex is your robot helper. It writes code when you ask. 🤖

2. You forget to tell Codex what colour your player is. What happens?

A It asks you

B It guesses

C It gives up

3. What's your folder called?

A My Arcade

B my-arcade

C arcade1

Slide 15 of 25

2:41 to 2:44 · 3 min

Quiz 2 of 3

Goal: Lock in Codex and the big idea that it guesses.

Say: Quick quiz before snack!

Do: Same as Quiz 1. After question 2 say: hold onto that one, it's what Mission 3 is about.

Kids do: Shout, one kid clicks.

If stuck: Answers: 1 B (writes code for you). 2 B (it guesses). 3 B (my-arcade).

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Snack break!

Stretch. Snack. Screens down. 😊

10:00 Tap to start

⌵

Slide 16 of 25

2:44 to 2:54 · 10 min

Snack break

Goal: Rest.

Say: Snack break! Screens down.

Do: Press S for 10 minutes. Use this time to fix anyone still stuck on setup.

Kids do: Snack and stretch.

Mission 3

What if you just told Codex: "make a game"? 🤔

**Racing?****Zombies?****Puzzle?****It would just guess! So you need to tell it your plan.**

Slide 17 of 25

2:54 to 2:56 • 2 min

Mission 3: "make a game"

Goal: They feel why a plan matters before you teach it.**Say:** Mission 3! What if you just told Codex: make a game? What would you get?**Do:** Let them shout guesses. Press the right arrow three times: racing, zombies, puzzle. Last press: it would just guess, so you need to tell it your plan.**Kids do:** Guess.

Mission 3

Write your game plan in 3 lines

**Who plays** One player**On screen** A frog 🐸 hops across a road with the arrow keys. Cars zoom by.**Win or lose** Cross 5 times to win. Get hit 3 times and you lose.**Real game companies do this too. It's called a PRD. 😊**

Slide 18 of 25

2:56 to 2:59 • 3 min

Write your plan in 3 lines

Goal: They learn the 3-line plan (PRD).**Say:** Here's how you tell Codex your plan. Three lines. Who plays. What's on screen and which keys. How you win or lose. Real game companies do this too, it's called a PRD.**Do:** Read the frog example out loud, one line at a time.**Kids do:** Listen.

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🔧 Watch me build mine

My game: Dragon Dash

👤 Who plays

One player

👁️ On screen

A baby dragon flies through a castle at night. Space to flap, F to breathe fire 🔥. Gems and bats!

🚩 Win or lose

Grab 30 gems 💎 to win. Get hit 3 times and you lose.

Why mine's gonna be awesome 🔥

- I said what it looks like
- I said every key
- I said how you win

Slide 19 of 25

2:59 to 3:03 · 4 min

Watch me build mine: Dragon Dash

Goal: They watch you write a great plan and see why a clear plan makes a better game. This is your project all term, built alongside theirs.

Say: This is my game for this term, Dragon Dash. Watch me write my plan. See how I say exactly what it looks like, every key, and how you win? That's why mine's gonna be awesome. Same AI, better plan.

Do: Switch to VS Code. In your dragon-dash folder, make prd.md and type the 3 lines live, thinking out loud. Then send the exact same prompt they will use. While it builds, point at the right side of the slide.

Kids do: Watch.

If stuck: Test this at home first and save the result. If the live build is slow or weird, open your saved version.

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🎮 Mission 3

Your turn! Write your plan

Make a new file called **prd.md** and fill this in:

Who plays: ____

On screen: ____ moves with the ____ keys. ____

Win or lose: ____ to win. ____ and you lose.

Your own idea! The weirder the better. 

7:00 Tap to start

↺

Slide 20 of 25

3:03 to 3:10 · 7 min

Your turn: write your plan

Goal: Every kid has their OWN 3-line plan in prd.md.

Say: Your turn! Make a new file called prd.md and fill in the 3 lines. Your own idea, the weirder the better.

Do: Press S for 7 minutes. Walk around and read every plan before they send it.

Kids do: Write prd.md.

If stuck: Plan too big (Fortnite, Counter-Strike): love it, what's the ONE best part? Build that, save the rest for later. Copying Dragon Dash: ask what game THEY would want to play.

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Mission 3

Now send it to Codex 

Read prd.md and build that game as one file named game.html.

 **Only ONE try!**
No fixing today.

 **Guess first**
What do you think it'll get wrong?

Slide 21 of 25

3:10 to 3:12 · 2 min

Send it to Codex

Goal: Everyone builds from their plan with ONE prompt.

Say: Copy this exactly into Codex. Only one try, no fixing today. Before you play, guess: what do you think it'll get wrong?

Do: Watch for kids sending a second prompt. Hold the line kindly: write down what's wrong, we fix it next week.

Kids do: Send the prompt, write a guess.

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Mission 3

Play it 3 times, then check 

**Did it listen?**
Yes or no for each line of your plan

**Surprises?**
What did it add that you didn't ask for?

 **Is it fun?**
Would you play it again?

5:00 Tap to start

Slide 22 of 25

3:12 to 3:17 · 5 min

Play it and check

Goal: They compare the game to their plan. The real lesson of Week 1.

Say: Play it 3 times. Then check 3 things. Did it listen, yes or no for each line? Any surprises, stuff it added that you didn't ask for? And is it actually fun?

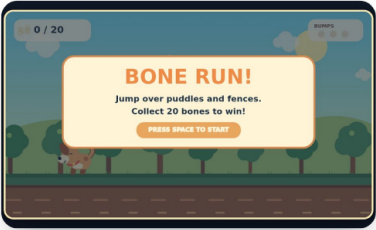
Do: Press S for 5 minutes. Ask a few kids what surprises they found. Show your Dragon Dash next to theirs.

Kids do: Play and check.

If stuck: If a game did everything right, go to the other two checks: what did it add without asking (it guessed), and would you play it again?

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My first game did everything I asked... and it was SO boring 😴
So I changed my plan. Then I couldn't stop playing! 🐶

You're the boss of the plan. Not the AI! 💪

🔗 Swap seats. Play their game. Guess their plan!

4:00 Tap to start

🔄

Slide 23 of 25

3:17 to 3:22 · 5 min

My story + swap

Goal: Land the big idea: they're the boss of the plan. Then a fun swap.

Say: My first game did everything I asked, and it was SO boring. So I changed my plan, made a puppy running through mud, and I couldn't stop playing. Same AI. Only my plan changed. You're the boss of the plan, not the AI!

Do: Press the right arrow to show the green line. Then: swap seats, play your neighbour's game and guess their plan before reading it. Press S for 4 minutes.

Kids do: Swap and guess.

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? Quiz 3 of 3

Class score: 1 / 3 ★

1. Which one makes things move?

A 🐭 HTML B 🐭 CSS **C 🧠 JavaScript**

JavaScript is the brain. It makes things move! 🧠

2. Why do we write a plan first?

A To make it faster B So Codex doesn't guess **c Because it's homework**

3. Whose job is it to make the game fun?

A The AI's B Mine! **C The laptop's**

Slide 24 of 25

3:22 to 3:26 · 4 min

Quiz 3 of 3

Goal: Wrap up the 3 big ideas of the day.

Say: Last quiz!

Do: Same as before. If Caution Tape gives you the official live quiz, run it here instead. Then read the checklist out loud: cracked the calculator, saw Hello from my arcade, wrote prd.md, made a game.

Kids do: Shout, one kid clicks.

If stuck: Answers: 1 C (JavaScript). 2 B (so Codex doesn't guess). 3 B (mine!).



Who wants to show their game?

Next week: we fix our games and put them online! 🌐



Bring:

- Your yes / no list
- A parent to help you sign in to GitHub

3:26 to 3:30 • 4 min

Show off + next week

Goal: End on a high.

Say: Who wants to show their game? Next week we fix our games and put them online. Bring your yes/no list, and a parent needs to help you sign in to GitHub.

Do: 1 or 2 kids show their game on the projector. Big clap for each. Make sure everyone knows where their my-arcade folder is before they leave.

Kids do: Show off, clap, pack up.